

PUBLIC SAFETY

Help that arrives too late

In an emergency, minutes matter. Alerts and evacuation notices often go out in one language, in official wording, through channels many families never see. The people who most need the message get it last.

How might we get one clear, trusted emergency message to a family that would otherwise miss it?

START HERE

Think of an emergency near you: a fire, a flood, an outage. How did your family find out? Who on your street would not have understood the alert?

WHERE AI CAN WORK

- Translating an official alert into the languages a neighborhood speaks
- Turning a long notice into three clear steps
- Answering follow-up questions using only the official information

YOU COULD BUILD

- An alert translator: official notice in, plain-language versions out
- A family emergency plan builder that makes a one-page plan
- A neighborhood check-in plan so people who live alone are not missed

THINK ABOUT (THIS IS SCORED)

A wrong translation can hurt someone; who checks it? Your tool must never replace 911 or invent instructions. What about someone with no smartphone?

YOUR DAY

- 9:45** Meet your squad. Read this page.
- 10:00** Pick one real person with this problem.
- 10:30** Problem sentence read to your coach.
- 10:30** Build version one.
- 11:45** Lunch
- 12:30** Finish. Make your risks slide.
- 1:10** Stop building. Practice the pitch.
- 1:30** Pitch to your track: 3 minutes.
- 2:15** Finals and awards, Dyer Hall

HOW YOU ARE SCORED

- 25 Problem clarity:** real, specific, belongs to a person
- 25 Use of AI:** AI does real work, not decoration
- 20 Feasibility:** someone could use it and it would matter
- 15 Responsible design:** bias, privacy, who could be harmed
- 15 The pitch:** clear, honest, everyone speaks

Squad name: _____ Who we are building for: _____

YOUR PROBLEM SENTENCE — write it before you build anything

_____ (a real person) struggles with _____
 because _____. We will build _____
 so they can _____.

YOUR 3-MINUTE PITCH

Meet the person (30 sec). Their problem today (30). What you built and what the AI does, shown live if you can (75). What could go wrong and your safeguard (30). What comes next (15).

RULES

Coaches and mentors help, but never build or present for you. Never type real private information about anyone into an AI tool. Check what the AI tells you; it can be confidently wrong. A working app, a set-up AI assistant, a clickable mockup, or a clear plan with one worked example can all win.

NOTES & SKETCHES

Toolkit links and all six challenges
longbeachaihackathon.org/briefs



WORKFORCE

The job you were qualified for

People apply for jobs and hear nothing back. Often they already have most of what the posting asks for. They just describe it in different words, or do not realize their experience counts.

How might we help one person see, and show, that they are already qualified?

START HERE

Think of someone you know who is job hunting or stuck in a job below their skills. What can they do that never shows up on paper? What posting would they be afraid to apply for?

WHERE AI CAN WORK

- Translating real experience (babysitting, a family shop, a team, a side hustle) into the skills employers name
- Comparing a person to a posting: what matches, what is missing, how to close the gap
- Running a practice interview and giving honest feedback

YOU COULD BUILD

- A skills translator: describe what you have done in your own words, get résumé lines
- A “posting decoder” showing what a job really asks for and a path to get there
- An interview practice partner for one specific job

THINK ABOUT (THIS IS SCORED)

The AI must not invent experience the person does not have. Hiring tools can carry bias about names, schools, and gaps; how do you avoid adding to it? A résumé holds private details.

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